

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Tuesday, December 14, 2021, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
At-Large Councilor Dale Girard
At-Large Councilor Michael Demars
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone

Absent:

Ward II Councilor James Contois

CITIZEN’S FORUM

No one spoke.

OLD BUSINESS

Transition Planning Follow-Up

A motion was made by Councilor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to suspend Council Rules.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne - yes

Girard - yes

Demars - yes

Damren - no

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 7-1.

A motion was made by Councilor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to add a Non-Public Session pursuant to RSA 91-A3,II(b) for Personnel at the end of the meeting and to not invite anyone into the session.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne - yes

Girard - yes

Demars - yes

Damren - no

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Stone - yes

Lovett - no

Motion carried 5-3.

Councilor Girard said he reached out to MRI (Municipal Resources Inc.). He said that John MacLean, Claremont’s former Interim City Manager, is willing to come back to Claremont in January, when City Manager Ed Morris leaves. Written into the proposed agreement is to pay Mr. MacLean an hourly rate of \$95; it is anticipated he will not exceed 30 hours per week; he will be onsite an average of two days a week, and he will be available by phone and video conference at other times. He wants the authority to appoint a temporary Assistant City Manager (someone from Staff) in order to have someone onsite to work with staff when he’s not here. There is a Travel Fee of \$145 per day in the agreement. Councilor Girard said that Mr. Morris has stated that he would be available after he leaves to answer questions. Councilor Girard said that Mr. MacLean thinks this will be a 4-to-6 month process.

Councilor Girard said that Mr. MacLean plans to be here on January 7th (Mr. Morris’ last day) for a “hand off.” That will be Mr. MacLean’s official start date, but that he may reach out to Department Heads prior to that.

After discussion, a majority of the Council agreed that Mr. MacLean will start on January 7, 2022.

A motion was made by Councilor Matteau and seconded by Councilor Stone to enter into a contract, as presented, for services between the City of Claremont and MRI (Municipal Resources Inc.) for an Interim City Manager.

Roll call vote:

O’Hearne - yes

Girard - yes

Demars - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

There was discussion about the City Manager search process including:

- Sending out an RFP for a search company
- Not wanting a search committee
- This is one of the most critical things the Council does
- Use MRI for the process
- Use Indeed
- Concern for the costs of hiring a search company
- MRI offers different processes

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Matteau to authorize Mayor-Elect Girard and Assistant Mayor-Elect Matteau to contact Alan Gould, Municipal Resources Inc., and to indicate to him that the Claremont City Council desires to enter into an all-inclusive contract for searching for a new City Manager for the City of Claremont and to ask him to put together a contract with pricing using that approach and send it to Mayor-Elect Girard and Assistant-Mayor Elect Matteau for them to forward on to Council Clerk Dorée Russell, to be forwarded to rest of the Council to see if they agree.

There was a brief discussion about the different approaches, and Councilor Stone said he wanted this to be brought to the newly elected Council in January.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - no

Girard - yes

Demars - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Stone - no

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 6-2.

Councilors agreed to meet December 21, 6:30 p.m., provided Councilor Girard is able to get information and forward it to the rest of the Council.

NON-PUBLIC SESSION PURSUANT TO RSA 91-A:3,II(b) – PERSONNEL

A motion was made by Councilor Stone and seconded by Councilor Matteau to enter Nonpublic Session pursuant to RSA 91-A:3,II(a) – Personnel.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Girard - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 7-1.

Entered nonpublic session at 7:20 p.m.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Matteau to exit the Non-Public Session.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Girard - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Public session reconvened at 7:43 p.m.

A motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor Matteau to seal these minutes, because it is determined that divulgence of this information likely would affect adversely the reputation of any person other than a member of this board; such minutes to remain sealed unless and until the purpose for which the information discussed has been requested to be sealed no longer applies.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Girard - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - no

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 7-1.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 7:50 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Damren and seconded by Councilor O'Hearne to adjourn.

Roll call vote:

O'Hearne - yes

Girard - yes

Sweetser - yes

Damren - yes

Matteau - yes

Koloski - yes

Stone - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council